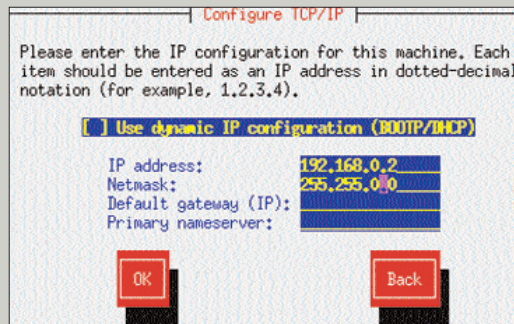


Set up a network

Your old computer is going to get much more useful if you network it. Setting up a basic network is easy—all you need is two Ethernet cards, a cross-crimped network cable, and some change of settings on the two machines.

On the primary computer, enable file and printer sharing, and set the IP to, say, 192.168.0.1. Set the IP for the secondary computer to 192.168.0.2 and set the subnet mask for both computers to 255.255.0.0.

You're done! These IPs can be anything in the 192.168.x.x series, where x is between 0 and 255.



Networking two computers requires you to change the IP settings on the two machines, and that's about it

DJ, play that song

You can turn your old computer into a music server. If you have Windows installed on your primary machine, there are two ways to do this. One way is to install Windows on the old computer, install Winamp, and then run a ShoutCast server. For details on setting up a ShoutCast server, see the *30 Minutes Expert* on page XX in this issue. Another way is to simply store all your MP3s on the old machine for anyone in the network to view and play.

You can also think of installing Linux on the old PC. This will allow you to play MP3s without installing a GUI. One of the popular command line tools is mpg321, a free tool that can be downloaded from <http://mpg321.sourceforge.net>. Before you can install this tool, you will need to install *libid3tag* and *libmad* (the MPEG audio decoder library). Red Hat Package Managers (RPM) packages for these can be found at www.rpmfind.net, and are hardly a few KBs in size. Even mpg321 is just a 58 KB file. Once you've downloaded these files, copy them to your Linux machine and log in as root. First install *libmad* by issuing the following command:

```
rpm -ivh libmad-0.15.0b-2.fr.i386.rpm
```

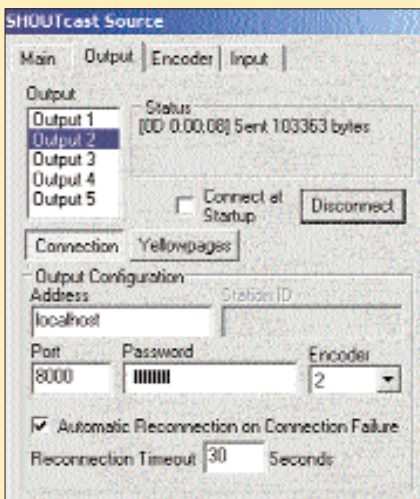
Then install *libid3tag* using:

```
rpm -ivh libid3tag-0.15.0b-0.1.rh73.fr.i386.rpm
```

Now go to the directory where your music is stored. Here, create a file named *list.pls* with the song names, and press [Enter] after each song. This will serve as your playlist. Now enter the following to start playing your music:

```
mpg321 -o oss --shuffle --list list.pls
```

Here '*-o oss*' specifies you'll be using default sound system for output; '*--shuffle*' specifies that the songs should play in random order; and '*--list list.pls*' specifies the playlist.



Run a ShoutCast server after installing Winamp, and your old PC is a music server

Servers of all sorts

You can turn your outdated computer into a file server, a Web server, a proxy server, or even a music server. Making a file server is easy. Simply create a folder and share it with write permissions. The best use for a file server would be to install Linux on it and use it for backups.

With Linux, the chances of your files getting infected with viruses are remote. Further, Linux gives you more stability. If you have other computers connected to this file server, you can use it as a repository for shared files, too.

To make your computer a print server, just attach your printer to the computer. Since printing doesn't require a powerful processor, older computers work fine. However, remember that depending on the drivers of the printer for various operating systems, you may need to install a newer version of operating system for the printer to work properly. Consequently, some old computers—even a 486 or Pentium 100—just might not do.

Setting up a computer as a gateway helps in several ways.

- You can share it with more than one computer;
- It caches Web sites, so frequently visited Web pages load faster.
- You don't need to set up a firewall on all the computers separately.
- You can maintain a log of what sites are being visited.

For this, first download Squid and install it using the following command:

```
rpm -ivh ....
```

Once it's installed, search for the *squid.conf* file. Normally it's located in the



Sites to visit

www.old-computers.com

A site dedicated to old computers. Has a discussion forum as well.

www.netfilter.org

The home page of the Netfilter/iptables project. Visit this site for information on iptables.

www.rpmfind.net

A search engine for RPM packages of all kinds.

www.486superlinks.tk

A source of old software for old machines.